UNIVERSITY OF LONDON

BSc EXAMINATION 2025

For Internal Students of
Royal Holloway

DO NOT TURN OVER UNTIL TOLD TO BEGIN

CS3003: IT Project Management

Time Allowed: **TWO** hours

Please answer **ALL** questions

Calculators are not permitted

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1.

(a) What is a Project Charter? Indicate **five** common elements of a project charter.

[8 marks]

(b) A Project Manager (PM) in a large corporation finds out that one of the projects she is managing is behind schedule. She decides to issue a change request. Which one of the following should such a change request authorise? **Justify** your answer.

- Additional resources using the project's contingency reserve
- Approval to use the project's contingency reserve
- Permission to ask the project team to work overtime in order to meet schedule
- Corrective actions based on the causes of the delay

[8 marks]

(c) You are the Project Manager in a software development project that is expected to run for six months with a project budget of £800,000 and a total development effort of 10,000 man-hours.

According to the project schedule, the project team should have had completed 38% of the work. As of today, 40% of the project work has been completed and 50% of the budget has been spent.

Using **exclusively earned-value management**, indicate which of the following statements is correct about the project. Justify your answer.

- The project is ahead of schedule and over budget
- The project is ahead of schedule and under budget
- The project is behind schedule and over budget
- The project is behind schedule and under budget

[10 marks]

(d) Explain the notion of a project's Risk Management Plan. Indicate **four** items that such a plan should contain.

[8 marks]

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2.

(a) You are managing a project in which there exist a number of unanticipated risks. Jointly with the project team you have identified a number of risk response strategies and respective actions that should be carried out to deal with such risks.

Using your decision-making authority as a project manager, which of the following ways is most appropriate to secure funding for dealing with those unanticipated project risks? **Justify** your answer.

- Submit a change request that asks for additional funding
- Use the management reserves
- Use the contingency reserves
- Use the existing project budget

[12 marks]

(b) The activities of a project and respective durations and dependencies are shown in the following table.

Activity	Duration (weeks)	Predecessors
A	10	-
B	15	A
C	20	A
D	32	B
E	35	B
F	5	D,E
G	2	C,F
H	1	G

(i) Draw a network diagram for this project including all floats. [10 marks]

(ii) Mark the project's critical path on the diagram. [3 marks]

(c) The term *baseline* is used in both project management and IT systems configuration management. Indicate whether each of the following statements is **true** or **false**. Briefly **justify** your answers.

(i) Project management baselines are used for project performance measurement and management.

(ii) Project management baselines help assess project variances and trends.

(iii) A project can have multiple budget and schedule baselines.

(iv) In IT systems configuration management, baselines are used to manage and control change.

[8 marks]

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3.

(a) Indicate whether each of the following statements is **true** or **false**. Briefly **justify** your answers.

(i) The "Issue Log" is an alternative name for a project's "Risk Register".

(ii) The "Delphi" estimation method depends on the existence of a historic model.

(iii) Change requests are a sign of poor project planning and should generally be avoided.

(iv) In configuration management, test scenarios are a valid configuration item.

[8 marks]

(b) One of the advantages of package-based software is "*the opportunity to obtain business know-how and adopt best-practices which are typically embedded in a software package*". Explain in your own words how you understand the reasoning for the above statement. Also, provide one example that illustrates its validity in the context of the functionality provided by a software application of your choice.

Note: An extensive analysis is not required but your answer should be sufficiently self-contained to make sense.

[7 marks]

(c) What is the Business Case document of a project? Provide and explain **three** of the typical pieces of content of a business case document.

[10 marks]

(d) Two members of your team are involved in a conflict. After discussing with both colleagues, you realise that the conflict is the result of a different understanding of the project's functional requirements and scope. Which of the following conflict resolution approaches would you apply in this case? **Justify** your answer.

- Impose a judgement
- Defuse
- Compromise

[8 marks]

END

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